



Calm Home Skills

Premium practice worksheet

CALM HOME SKILLS - LESSON 02

Turn chaotic greetings into clear, calm routines.

This worksheet helps owners teach their dog how to greet people without jumping, crashing forward, or spiraling into over-arousal.

TRAINER NOTE

Jumping is often a social skill problem, not a stubbornness problem. Show the dog what works instead.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner can use distance, reinforcement, and repetition to reward four paws on the floor and calmer approach behavior.

2 Practice plan

1

Start below threshold

Keep enough distance so your dog can notice the person without exploding forward.

2

Reward the behavior you want

Mark and reward four paws on the floor, check-ins, or a brief sit.

3

Approach only if calm

Move closer or allow greeting only when your dog stays organized.

4

Reset quickly

If your dog jumps or surges, calmly create distance and try an easier rep.



Calm Home Skills

Polite Greetings

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Leash or drag line
- ☐ High-value treats
- ☐ A helper person for controlled practice
- ☐ Mat or place spot for reset reps

Set up before you start

- ☐ Practice with one calm helper before trying real visitors.
- ☐ Begin at a distance where your dog can still think.
- ☐ Decide what behavior earns greeting access: sit, stand still, or four paws on

4 Greeting practice tracker

Date	Helper	Distance	Response	Reward	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



Calm Home Skills

Polite Greetings

6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Letting the dog rehearse jumping because “they are friendly.”
- Adding too much excitement from the helper.
- Trying to fix greetings only when real guests arrive.
- Allowing greeting access after frantic behavior.

If this happens, try this

- If the dog cannot stay grounded, increase distance and reward more often.
- If the dog sits then springs up, reward faster and keep the greeting shorter.
- If visitors excite the dog too much, use a mat or barrier at first.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I know what behavior earns greeting access.
- ☐ My dog can practice with one calm helper.
- ☐ I can reset without frustration when the rep goes wrong.
- ☐ The dog is showing more four-paws-on-floor behavior over time.

HOMEWORK

Run three greeting practice sessions this week with one helper. Record the easiest distance, best reward, and how many calm reps you achieved.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____